Dhana Karthikeya Ventrapragada

+1 (669) 269-8955 | vdkarthikeya@berkeley.edu | linkedin.com/in/vdkarthikeya | github.com/vdkarthikeya | vdkarthikeya.github.io

Education

University of California, Berkeley **Expected Dec 2027**

B.A. in Data Science and Applied Mathematics — GPA: 3.85/4.00 *Berkeley, CA*

- **Relevant Coursework:** Principles & Techniques of Data Science · Probability for Data Science · Data Structures · *In progress:* Introduction to Machine Learning · Efficient Algorithms & Intractable Problems · Data Engineering

Technical Skills

Languages: Python, SQL, Java

ML: PyTorch, TensorFlow, scikit-learn, XGBoost, LightGBM, SentenceTransformers, Embeddings, Cross-Validation

Data: pandas, NumPy, GeoPandas, Matplotlib, PostgreSQL, Jupyter

Engineering: FastAPI, Gemini API, Pydantic, AWS S3, ffmpeg, pytest, Git

Experience

IDX Exchange ↗ | **Data Science Intern** | **Remote** **Jun 2026 – Aug 2026**

- Developed a model that predicts California home sale prices, typically within **8.6%** of the actual price, using **71K** single-family sales cleaned from **143K** raw records.
- Benchmarked four model types and selected a tuned XGBoost (R^2 of **0.88**), finding that deeper trees improved accuracy more than a lower learning rate.
- Resolved a data leakage bug that had invalidated early results, and nearly halved a simpler model's error (from **29%** to **15%**) by engineering a school district feature.

Guang Labs ↗ | **Engineering Intern** | **Remote** **May 2026 – Aug 2026**

- Engineered a service for an AI video startup that classifies a user's image or video by content type (sports, gaming, talking, music) using Google's Gemini, retrying uncertain or malformed responses on different clips, up to **10** attempts.
- Validated the service end to end with real video clips after code review and expanded the automated test suite from 38 to **86** tests.
- Developed an in-app notification bell that alerts users when their video finishes processing or fails.

Fung Institute | Fung Fellow, Health + Innovation | Berkeley, CA **Aug 2026 – Present**

- Selected for Berkeley's industry-partner fellowship, placed on The After Collective project supporting wildfire survivors.
- Interviewed wildfire survivors about the tools and information they use, and organize the team's documentation.

Projects

SightLine (Open Projects, ML team) ↗ | *PyTorch, OpenCV, in progress*

- Developing an app that turns a day of Meta Ray-Ban smart glasses footage into a **60-second** highlight video; on the ML team, which splits footage into clips and uses audio and visual models to pick the best moments.

Movie Genre Classification ↗ | *Python, scikit-learn, SentenceTransformers*

- Built a model that reads a movie's title and plot summary and predicts all its genres, trained on **42K+** films.
- Raised the overall score (Macro F1) from 0.48 to **0.66** by giving each genre its own cutoff, and found a simple model beat complex ones while training **12**× faster.

Email Spam Classifier ↗ | *Python, scikit-learn*

- Built a spam filter from 50+ engineered signals (link counts, dollar signs, HTML) that correctly sorts **92.1%** of unseen emails.

Housing Price & Assessment Bias ↗ | *Python, pandas, scikit-learn*

- Built a model that estimates home values from **200K+** Chicago-area property records and checked which homes are over- or under-valued.

Leadership & Involvement

UC Berkeley CDSS | Reader/Tutor, CDSS 198 | Berkeley, CA **Aug 2026 – Present**

- Run exam reviews for intro CS and data science classes for transfer students, and give resume feedback.

UC Berkeley EECS | Course Staff (UCS1), CS 61A | Berkeley, CA **Jun 2026 – Aug 2026**

- Taught **4** weekly exam-prep sections, held office hours, helped write midterm and final questions, and led final review sessions.